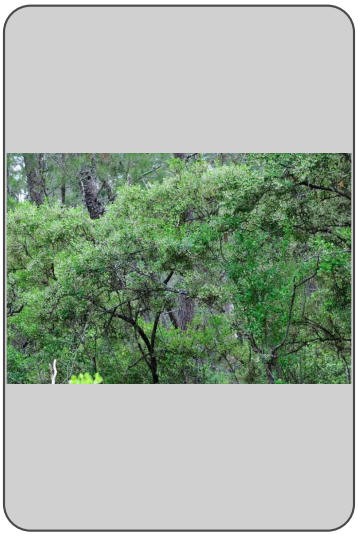
Vaccinium arboreum 'Persistence'

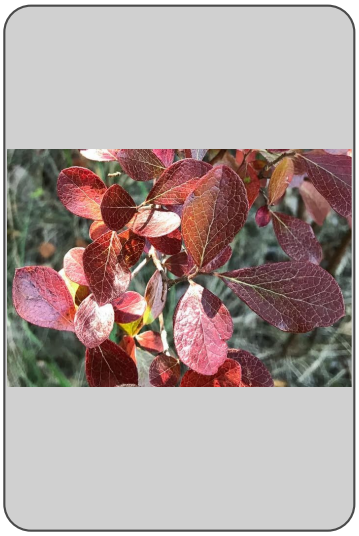
Persistence Sparkleberry

Family: Ericaceae

Passage: 4 | Rockery: 3 | **TOTAL 7**



HABIT



FALL



LEAF





FLOWER / FRUIT

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Small tree or large shrub

Evergreen or deciduous
Semi-evergreen

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: Species typically 10–20 ft tall (occasionally to 25 ft), 4–10 ft wide. Cultivar 'Persistence' follows species habit; no distinct size deviation stated in available

Sun

Water

Soil
Prefers well-drained sandy or rocky soils

Zone 8a
Species native to southeastern United States, Zones 6–9. Well suited to Atlanta Zone 8a. Semi-evergreen in the South

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Species native to southeastern and south-central United States. Cultivar 'Persistence' is a named selection; specific origin details not stated in primary

Form
Deciduous to semi-evergreen small tree or large shrub. Leaves glossy, leathery, elliptical, 1–3 in long. Fall color red to purplish in cooler years. Bark exfoliating, mottled gray-brown-red. White bell-shaped flowers in spring; shiny black berries persist into winter. Largest North American Vaccinium. Persistent winter fruit and attractive exfoliating bark. Cultivar-specific performance data limited; species characteristics used as proxy and labeled as such

Foliage
Not stated

Flowers and fruit
Not stated

Bark
Not stated

PLANTING NOTES

Establishment

Plant in full sun to light shade on well-drained soil. Drought tolerant once established. Can be trained to single or multi-trunk form

HEALTH

Health

No serious problems stated for the species. Berries are dry and not highly palatable to humans but valued by wildlife

Symptoms

None stated